Movement', largely drawn from a newly emergent urban elite created in large part by the colonial and missionary educational system and largely made up of higher-caste, non-Brahmin Shaivas determined to reject what they saw as the polytheistic religious practices introduced by the Arya Brahmins through the medium of Sanskrit in favour of *Tamilar matam*, the true Tamil religion, which they saw as the worship of Lord Shiva alone through the liturgical medium of Tamil.

Some notable Tamil Brahmins also joined their ranks, including the historian T. R. Sesha Iyengar, whose book *Dravidian India*, first published in 1925, is still widely read today.[14] 'Geological research has shown that the Indian Ocean was once a continent,' wrote Iyengar, 'and that this submerged continent, sometimes called Lemuria, originally extended from Madagascar to Malay Archipelago, connecting South India with Africa and Australia … There are unmistakable indications in the Tamil traditions that the land affected by the deluge was contiguous with *Tamilakam*, and that, after the subsidence, the Tamils naturally betook themselves to their northern provinces.'

This still appears to be a widely accepted Tamil view of its history today, a reading promoted in schools, colleges and temples and in Tamil Nadu government publications. The rest of the world may have moved on in accepting the validity of a dating that puts the Indian Plate's final break with Gondwanaland towards the close of the later Mesozoic – approximately seventy million years too early for the human race – but in Tamil country the lost continent of Kumarikkantam comes close to being accepted as an established fact of history as *Kumarinatu*, the fountain-head of Tamil identity.

There is no reason why a belief in a lost or drowned land should not be taken seriously. As mentioned earlier, the last major glaciation caused sea levels to fall, resulting in the